

SEMINAR 2

History of AI

9th of April 2025

Flora Pennartz

f.e.pennartz@vu.nl

	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
Week 1	31/3 13:30 – 15:15 MF-FG2 Lecture 1 (reading: none)	1/4 17:30-18.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	2/4 09:00-10:45 HG-14A36 Book recap & working on assignment 11:00 Assignment 1 13:30-14:15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap 14:30-15.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	3/4 15:30-16:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 16:30-17:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 17:30-18:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 18:30-19:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback	4/4
Week 2	7/4 13:30 – 15:15 MF-FG2 Lecture 2 (reading: Ch. 4 and 5)	8/4 17:30-18.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	9/4 09:00-10:45 HG-14A36 Book recap & working on assignment 11:00 Assignment 2 13:30-14:15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap 14:30-15.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	10/4 15:30-16:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 16:30-17:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 17:30-18:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 18:30-19:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback	11/4
Week 3	14/4 13:30 – 15:15 MF-FG2 Lecture 3 (reading: Ch. 6 and 7)	15/4 17:30-18.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	16/4 09:00-10:45 HG-14A36 Book recap & working on assignment 11:00 Assignment 3 13:30-14:15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap 14:30-15.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	17/4 15:30-16:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 16:30-17:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 17:30-18:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 18:30-19:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback	18/4
Week 4	21/4 <i>Easter Monday: lecture moved to Wednesday.</i>	22/4 <i>Lecture recap moved to Thursday.</i>	23/4 09:00-10:45 HG-14A36 Book recap & working on assignment 11:00 Assignment 4 11:00 – 12:45 HG-14A00 Lecture 4 (reading: Ch. 8 and 9) 17:30-18.15 13:30-14:15	24/4 11:00-11.45 NU-2B01, NU-2B11 Lecture recap 15:30-16:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 16:30-17:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 17:30-18.15 13:30-14:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11	25/4

			HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap 14:30-15.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	Assignment feedback 18:30-19:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback	
May holiday	28/4	29/4	30/4	1/5	2/5
Week 5	5/4 <i>Fifth of May: lecture moved to Wednesday.</i>	6/4 <i>Lecture recap moved to Thursday.</i>	7/4 09:00-10:45 HG-14A36 Book recap & working on assignment 11:00 Assignment 5 11:00 – 12:45 HG-14A00 Lecture 5 (reading: Ch. 10 and 11) 13:30-14:15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap 14:30-15.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	8/4 11:00-11.45 NU-2B01, NU-2B11 Lecture recap 15:30-16:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 16:30-17:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 17:30-18:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 18:30-19:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback	9/4
Week 6	12/5 13:30 – 15:15 MF-FG2 Lecture 6 (reading: Ch. 12 and 13)	13/5 17:30-18.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	14/5 09:00-10:45 HG-14A36 Book recap & working on assignment 11:00 Assignment 6 13:30-14:15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap 14:30-15.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	15/5 15:30-16:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 16:30-17:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 17:30-18:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback 18:30-19:15 NU-4B05, NU-4B11 Assignment feedback	16/5
Week 7	19/5 13:30 – 15:15 MF-FG2 Lecture 7 (reading: Ch. 14 and 15)	20/5 17:30-18.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	21/5 09:00-10:45 HG-14A36 Book recap & exam practice 13:30-14:15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap 14:30-15.15 HG-OG28, HG-OG30 Lecture recap	22/5 08:30 – 10:45/11:15 SCVU-1 1/2/3/4/5/6/7/8 Exam	23/5
Week 8	26/5	27/5	28/5	29/5	30/5

Outline of this seminar

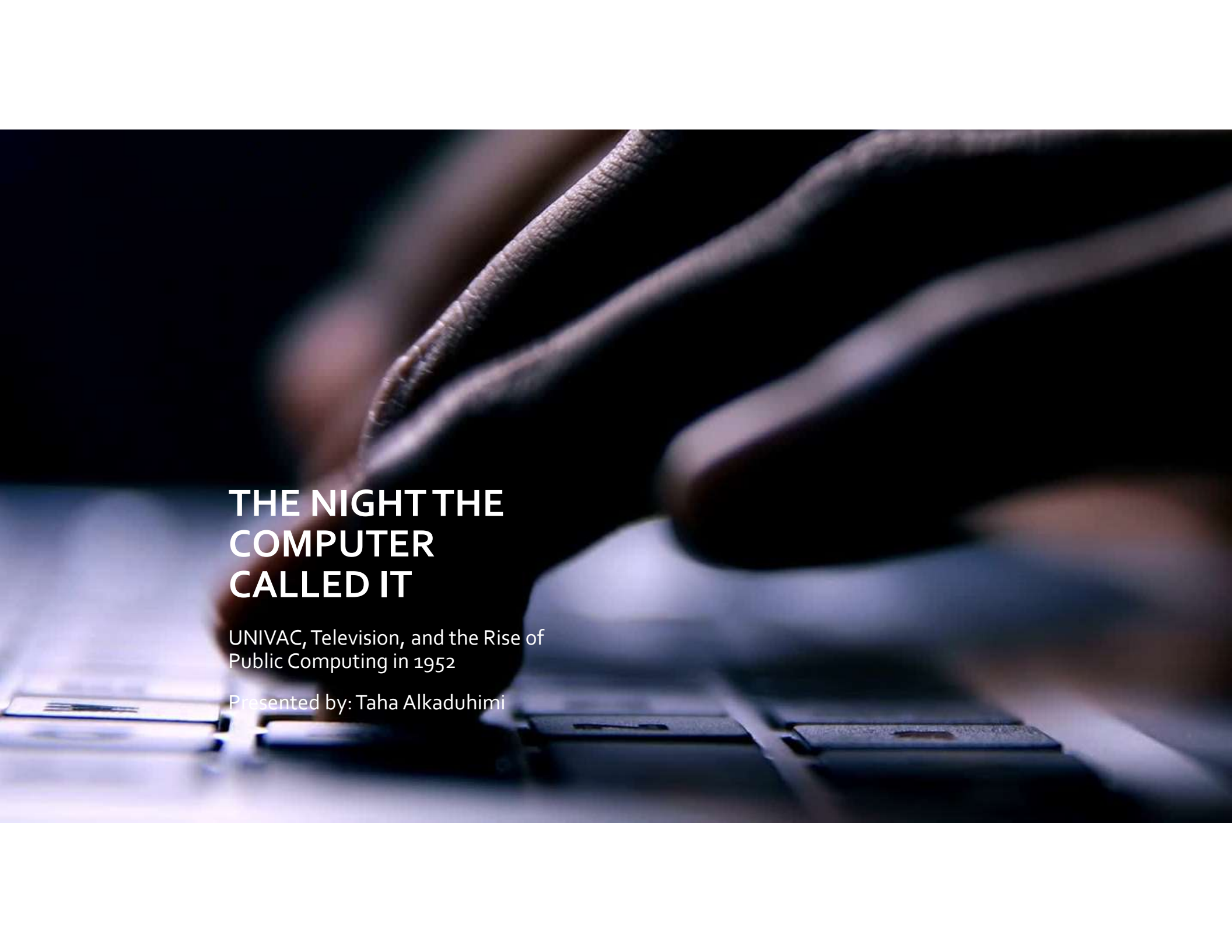
- Chapter 4 recap by Feruza
 - Chapter 5 recap by Taha
 - Break
 - Essay structure
 - “To what extent”
 - Working on assignment 2
- At the end of this session, you’ve recapped chapter 4 and 5 and completed assignment 2!

Chapter recap planning

	Chapter	Student 1	Student 2	Student 3
Week 2	Ch. 4	Feruza		
	Ch. 5	Taha		
Week 3	Ch. 6	Omm		
	Ch. 7	Walid		
Week 4	Ch. 8	Kayi		
	Ch. 9			
Week 5	Ch. 10	Yi		
	Ch. 11			
Week 6	Ch. 12			
	Ch. 13			
Week 7	Ch. 14			
	Ch. 15			

Chapter 4 recap by Feruza

Chapter 5 recap by Taha



THE NIGHT THE COMPUTER CALLED IT

UNIVAC, Television, and the Rise of
Public Computing in 1952

Presented by: Taha Alkaduhimi

America in 1952



Post-WWII
economic boom



Cold War anxiety



Eisenhower (R) vs.
Stevenson (D)



Rise of television
in politics

Introducing UNIVAC

Developed by
Eckert &
Mauchly

First
commercial
computer

Used magnetic
tape

1,000
calculations/sec

UNIVAC's Shocking Prediction

- 3.4M votes in: UNIVAC predicted:
- Eisenhower 438 vs Stevenson 93
- '00 to 1' odds for Eisenhower

CBS's Doubt

Prediction
seemed too
extreme

CBS didn't
announce it
immediately

Operators
doubted the
result

UNIVAC Was Right

Final result:
Eisenhower
442

UNIVAC was
nearly perfect

Public was
stunned

Why It Mattered



Tech
breakthrough



Cultural shift:
trust in machines



Media evolution:
data in news

The Authors' Perspective



MARKED START OF
INFORMATION AGE

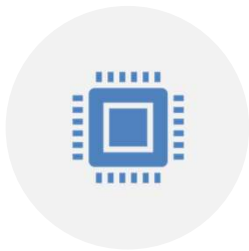


FIRST PUBLIC ROLE
FOR COMPUTING



MADE COMPUTING
VISIBLE, ACCESSIBLE

UNIVAC's Legacy



BOOSTED COMMERCIAL
COMPUTING



NORMALIZED DATA
ANALYSIS



INSPIRED MODERN
TECH USE

Discussion Points



Can we trust machine predictions?



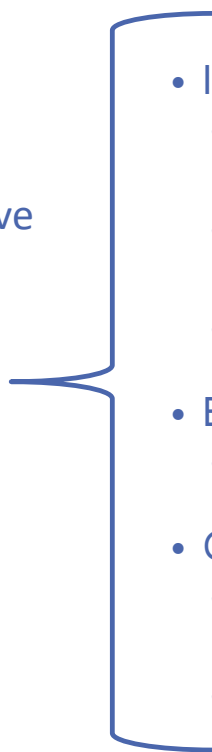
What if machines and humans disagree?



Are we reliving this today with AI?

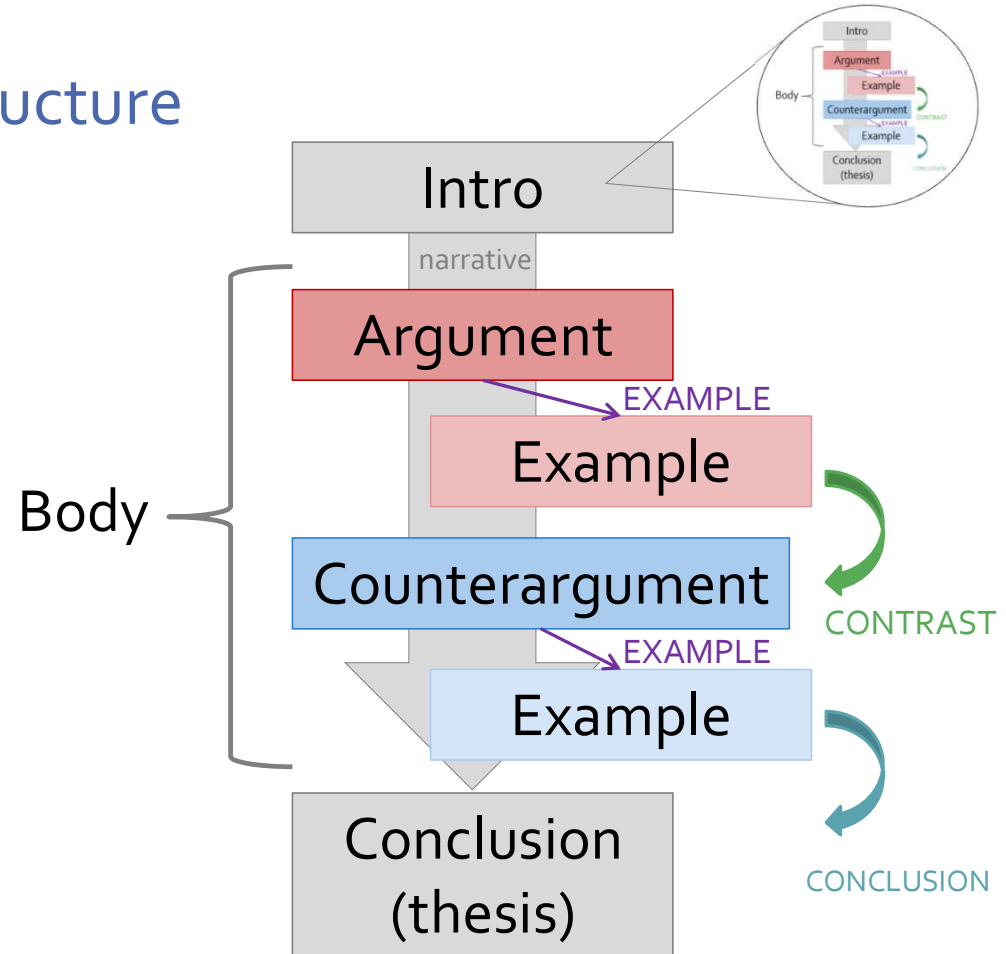
BREAK

Essay structure: outline of an essay

- What is an essay?
 - Statement (thesis)/question → narrative
(here, the “thesis” is defined by the exam question)
 - Structure: intro, body, conclusion
- 
- Intro
 - Tell what the reader can expect in the following text
 - Perhaps one sentence summarizing your content
 - Advanced: a question, anecdote or statistic
 - Body
 - The actual content
 - Conclusion
 - Summary, repeating of the question/statement if present
 - Advanced: follow-up question

Essay structure: building a structure

1. Define your content (notes) → thesis
2. Design your structure
3. "Fill in" the structure
4. Check your work
 - a. Did you answer all the questions?
 - b. Does your answer make sense?
 - c. Do you have an intro, a body and a conclusion?
 - d. Did you use the appropriate signal words?
 - e. Does the narrative make sense?



NB: This is an example of a structure

Essay structure: signal words

- How to find a fitting narrative?
 - Work towards your thesis
 - Use signal words – they are “labels” so that the reader knows what to expect next

I love tiramisu **because** it's creamy, sweet, **and** a little bitter. I like panna cotta, **too**, **but** tiramisu is creamier. **For example**, I could eat two servings without regret. **In the end**, tiramisu is my favorite dessert

- Final tip: reading out loud

ADDITION

A and B

and
firstly, secondly...
additionally
also

COMPARISON

A resembles B

similarly
likewise
in the same way
too

CONTRAST

A contradicts B

but
On one hand, on other hand...
however
in contrast

EXAMPLE

A illustrates B

for example
for instance
such as
also

CAUSAL

A causes B

because
so
since
thus

CONCLUSION

of thesis

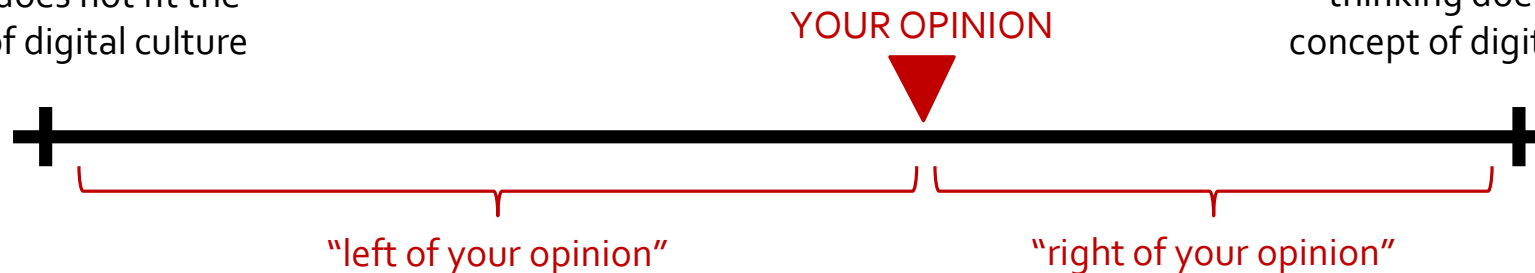
in the end
ultimately
in conclusion
to sum up

“To what extent” (Dutch: “in hoeverre”)

To what extent does the concept of systems thinking fit the concept of digital culture?

The concept of systems thinking does not fit the concept of digital culture

The concept of systems thinking does fit the concept of digital culture



- Explain your “point on the line,” so the part left of it and the part right of it

Assignment 2.1: Dutch Dinosaurs

During the lecture the focus was on a number of Dutch computer pioneers.

- a. Name two of these Dutch pioneers (the machines and their users / builders, that is) and elaborate on their achievements.
- b. Explain in what way(s) these pioneers were representative for early Dutch computing: in what way(s) did they deviate from the developments in the US. In what way(s) did they not deviate.

- a) Refine the structure of your answer. Is it clear where the intro starts, where the body starts and where the conclusion starts?
- b) Did you answer all the questions?
- c) Exchange with neighbor for feedback.

- a) Intro
- b) Pioneer 1, achievements
- c) Pioneer 2, achievements
- d) Representative?
- e) Deviate?
- f) Not deviate?
- g) Conclude

Assignment 2.2 Moore school

In what ways was Moore school relevant in the history of computing?
Distinguish between the pre-war, war and post-war period.

- a) Refine the structure of your answer. Is it clear where the intro starts, where the body starts and where the conclusion starts?
- b) Did you answer all the questions?
- c) Exchange with neighbor for feedback.

Assignment 2.3 Alan Turing

To what extent can Alan Turing be regarded as the father of AI?

- a) Refine the structure of your answer. Is it clear where the intro starts, where the body starts and where the conclusion starts?
- b) Did you answer all the questions?
- c) Exchange with neighbor for feedback.

- 1. Intro [10%]
- 2. Pro (example)
- 3. Con (example)
- 4. Conclusie [10%]

Heads-up

- Coming week:
 - Lecture on Monday (prepare by reading Ch. 6 and 7, prepare a few slides if you're up to present)
 - Lecture recap on Tuesday / Wednesday
 - Book recap/assignment seminar on Wednesday
 - Assignment feedback on Thursday
 - Next Wednesday we'll discuss more essay writing techniques and practice with assignment 3

QUESTIONS?

See you next week!